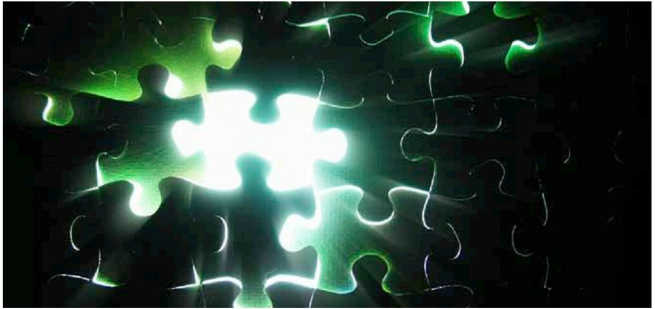


Top Mind Mapping Tools for Android

Mind mapping can be done on a piece of paper or on your smartphone, tablet, laptop and computer. Here's a look at five open source mind mapping tools used on Android.



It is said that a picture is worth a thousand words. Then, what if that picture depicts the thoughts in your mind? It can be the most powerful diagram you will ever have, and that is exactly what mind mapping does. A mind map is a radial diagram with the key term in the centre and the associated ideas radiating as branches and sub-branches.

The term 'mind map' was introduced by Tony Buzan, a popular British author and television personality. It is basically about how our brain takes care of thoughts. Our brain always looks for patterns, and a mind map stores information as a pattern. So each piece of information is linked to the next one. Studies have shown that mind maps increase the retention capacity of the brain by 10 per cent over the baseline for a text of 600-words compared to other study methods. This suggests that learning mind mapping might be a good idea.

As mentioned earlier, a mind map is nothing but a diagram showing the wild patterns in your mind and the train of your thoughts. In this article, let's explore some mind mapping tools used in the digital world. Readers unfamiliar with mind mapping could first practice it on paper and later move to the software app. Here are five open source mind mapping tools used on Android.

SimpleMind

SimpleMind is a mind mapping tool available for the Mac OS, the iPhone, Windows and on Android. The free version available for Android on Google Play has the following features:

- Easy to use—drag, arrange and edit topics on the Mind Map page.

- Tap or drag 'Node Well' to add new Topics.
- Undo/Redo in the 'Editor'.
- Reorganise structures using the drag-and-drop feature, aided by 'Topic auto-layout'.
- Cut, copy or paste to move or duplicate topics between mind maps.
- Apply visual styles—change colours, borders and lines for maximum presentation impact.
- Large mind map page support—the diagram's size is limited only by your memory.

iMindmap

iMindmap is the official software from the inventor of mind mapping, Tony Buzan.

The features of iMindmap are:

- Open .imx email attachments from the iMindmap desktop.
- The ability to add Web links and text notes.
- Templates to get you started fast.
- Brand new 'Sketch Tool'.
- In-built SmartLayout technology to keep your maps tidy.
- Tailor your maps with 'Styles' and 'Freehand Branches'.
- Undo/redo feature allows you to quickly amend or alter your mind maps.

The very first time you use iMindmap, you will have to register, free of cost. Once this is done, you can start making mind maps by creating the central node and then drawing branches by touch.